

ABITURPRÜFUNG 2005

LEISTUNGSFACH

ENGLISCH

(HAUPTTERMIN)

Arbeitszeit: 270 Minuten

Hilfsmittel: Einsprachiges Wörterbuch

Wählen Sie von den Aufgaben 1 und 2 **eine** zur Bearbeitung aus. Jede Aufgabe besteht aus den Prüfungsteilen A und B.

In den Prüfungsteilen A und B werden jeweils die inhaltliche und die sprachliche Leistung bewertet.

Rechts neben den Prüfungsteilen A bzw. B steht die jeweils maximal erreichbare Anzahl von Bewertungseinheiten (BE). Die angegebenen BE beinhalten die Bewertung für die inhaltliche **und** die sprachliche Leistung.

Die Anzahl der Wörter ist **für den Prüfungsteil B** zu vermerken.

ÖFFNUNG AM 11. MAI 2005

Task 1

(Text 1 "Is anybody listening?" on pages 5 to 6;

Text 2 "Euromyths? Most of them are just plain bananas ..." on page 7)

A

Working with the texts

Your class is doing a project on the European Union.

Do the following tasks, using your own words as far as appropriate.

After reading the materials provided, present the facts the reader gets on the European Union as clearly as possible and draw a conclusion on its image.

Evaluate the motives of Ms Kauppi (M.E.P.) and the two candidates for working in the European Parliament.

Describe the layout of text 2 and its effects on the reader.

31 BE

B

Composition

Choose **one** of the following tasks.

Write at least 400 words.

1. Interpret the cartoon.
(see cartoon on page 3)
2. *To be a leader, a follower, an opponent or an outsider?*
Comment on the role you adopt in different spheres of life.

31 BE



Source: www.politicalcartoons.com

Task 2

(Text "Nettles" on page 8)

A

Working with the text

Your class is doing a course on poetry. You have chosen the poem "Nettles" by Vernon Scannell.

Do the following tasks, using your own words as far as appropriate.

Interpret the poem:

Summarise the poem's content tracing the sequence of events.

Describe the characters.

Analyse the choice of poetic devices.

Identify the symbolic meaning of the incident with the nettles and explain the message for the reader.

31 BE

B

Composition

Choose **one** of the following tasks. Write at least 400 words.

1. *"There is always one moment in childhood when the door opens and lets the future in."*

Graham Greene (1904-91)

Reflect on the quotation.

2. *Imagine you have to face a serious problem in your life such as the fear of failing an exam, being betrayed by a friend, experiencing violence etc. You either ask your parents or friends for help.*

Create a dialogue.

31 BE

Task 1

Text 1

Is anybody listening?

Here's how one M.E.P.¹ is trying to convince an apathetic public that the E.U.'s legislature isn't just a gravy train

Not if you believe Piia-Noora Kauppi, 29, a fresh-faced dynamo finishing her first term as an M.E.P. [...]: "Yes, the European Parliament is a gravy train," she admits, but she insists that it does real, important work that affects people's lives: during the current term, for example, it has passed legislation giving air travelers more compensation if they're bumped from² an overbooked flight; ensuring ATM³ withdrawal charges are the same in all euro-zone countries; and banning cosmetics testing on animals by 2009. [...]



"We're a normal political institution," Kauppi says with typical earnestness. "Politicians here aren't more rotten or less capable than in a national parliament. Some of us take our jobs seriously."

But there's no sign that voters will take M.E.P.s' jobs seriously when they go to the polls next week to choose the 732 members of the next Parliament. Interest in—and respect for—the legislature is scraping bottom⁴. Turnout has sunk from 63% in 1979 to 49% in the last election in 1999. This time, only 45% definitely plan to vote, according to a Gallup/Eurobarometer poll. That's a shame, because the Parliament's clout has consistently been expanded with each E.U. treaty, and the new constitution now being hammered out will enhance its power even more. [...] A 2003 Eurobarometer survey found that only 35% of E.U. citizens felt that M.E.P.s represented their interests well. That's bad news to Kauppi, [...] a passionate believer in the Parliament's power to improve European life at both institutional and individual levels. [...] Kauppi hopes her enthusiasm will be contagious. The E.U.'s work "is too important to be left only to the political élites," she says.

STRASBOURG: THE STRUGGLE FOR REFORM

The European Parliament complex looms on Strasbourg's north side, a glass-and-steel behemoth⁵ ringed by a moatlike road and guarded by unnaturally tidy rows of immature trees, which look vaguely like green and brown barbed wire. Kauppi says the massive exterior has the aura of "a medieval castle," cold, forbidding and inaccessible—an apt description of how most people see the E.U. itself.

But what many in the Parliament think is truly medieval is the setup that requires them to pack up and move from their regular offices in Brussels to Strasbourg once a month. The bizarre commute – which involves each M.E.P.'s office packing all they need for the week into giant metal trunks that are shipped, unpacked for a few days, then repacked and sent back to Brussels – is the product of a typical E.U. backroom deal. When the Belgian capital was chosen as the E.U.'s home in 1958, France blocked an agreement until it got the Parliament's Strasbourg outpost as a consolation prize. The cost to taxpayers: €200 million a year. This is one E.U. excess Kauppi would like to stamp out. [...]

BRUSSELS: GETTING DOWN TO BUSINESS

If Strasbourg is the Parliament's showroom, Brussels is its factory floor. [...] No bill gets to the full Parliament without going through the committees, where M.E.P.s consult other E.U. officials

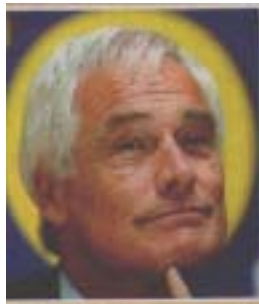
as well as representatives of business, industry and NGOs⁶. [...] Committee work “can be a bit boring, but it's very important,” says Kauppi as she heads back to her office. “What we do there has a political role as well as an economic role.” [...]

50 While M.E.P.s still tend to vote for their own national interests, Kauppi could turn out to be the prototype for a new generation of truly European politicians with a stronger commitment to represent “Europe”.

IN THE RUNNING

Thousands of people from all walks of life are vying for seats in the European Parliament

ROBERT KILROY-SILK



U.K. Independence Party candidate Kilroy-Silk, 62, has one goal: “To get Britain out of Brussels.” Axed from a BBC talk show in January after calling Arabs “limb amputators” and

“women repressors,” the erstwhile Labour M.P. has nothing good to say about the E.U. either. It's bad, corrupt, bureaucratic,”and he's outraged that Britain put €2.9 billion more into the E.U.'s 2002 budget than it got back. The E.U., he says, “is going to implode. We should have a civilized, amicable divorce while it's still possible.”

CARMEN KASS



“I'm not a politician,” says *Vogue* cover girl Kass, 25, a candidate of Estonia's ruling center-right Res Publica party. In 11 years of modeling, “I've seen beauty and I've seen beasts”—surely good prep⁷ for politics.

Her approach is earnest, even solemn; she credits that to an early childhood spent under Soviet rule. Now she's savoring the freedom to participate. “It's so important for the youth to be involved, to create our own future,” Kass says. “More love and attention is needed—and less fear of putting yourself forward and getting involved.”

By Jeff Chu

From: TIME, June 7, 2004

Annotations:

- | | | |
|---|-------------------|--|
| 1 | M.E.P. | Member of the European Parliament |
| 2 | to be bumped from | to be excluded from |
| 3 | ATM | AE: automated teller machine; BE: cashpoint |
| 4 | to scrape bottom | to be at a very low level |
| 5 | behemoth | literary: something that is very large, or monstrous |
| 6 | NGO | non-governmental organization |
| 7 | prep | preparation |

Task 1

Text 2

Euromyths? Most of them are just plain bananas ...

	The myth	The reality
THE QUEEN	The Queen will be stripped of her powers as sovereign.	Nonsense. The UK is not the only country in the EU with a monarch (take Spain, Belgium, Denmark etc). It is the only country where this has become an issue. 
THE SUPER-EU	EU will become like a superstate with its own president, flag and anthem.	Misleading. The president of the Council will spend their life coordinating committees; the flag exists at the moment, as does the EU's unofficial anthem: Beethoven's Ode to Joy. 
IDENTITY CARDS	We will all have to carry EU identity cards. (Almost all other EU countries have identity cards, and closer European integration means it is seen as inevitable that the practice will spread to Britain.)	The government is moving in the direction of introducing ID cards. But that has little to do with the EU. It wants tighter controls for its own reasons. 
BANANAS	 Bendy Bananas are banned by Brussels. (Bananas must not be excessively curved.)	Bananas are classified according to quality and size. Individual governments and the industry have their own standards, the latter's particularly stringent. The European Commission was asked to draft legislation in this area. Following extensive consultation, the proposed quality standards were adopted in Council in 1994.

By Stephen Castle and Andrew Grice
From: The Independent, March 25, 2004

Task 2 Text

Nettles

My son aged three fell in the nettle bed.

'Bed' seemed a curious name for those green spears,

That regiment of spite behind the shed:

It was no place for rest. With sobs and tears

5 The boy came seeking comfort and I saw

White blisters beaded on his tender skin.

We soothed him till his pain was not so raw.

At last he offered us a watery grin,

10 And then I took my billhook, honed the blade

And went outside and slashed in fury with it

Till not a nettle in that fierce parade

Stood upright anymore. And then I lit

15 A funeral pyre to burn the fallen dead,

But in two weeks the busy sun and rain

Had called up tall recruits behind the shed:

My son would often feel sharp wounds again.



By Vernon Scannell

From: www.poemhunter.com 17.06.2004